

World in Brief: Trump says America and Iran are talking; wildfires in France and Spain



Photograph: Getty Images

Donald Trump said **America** was “having good talks” with **Iran**, but threatened to resume strikes if the negotiations failed. Mr Trump claimed that Iran had directly requested the talks, although Iran denied this. Fighting between the two countries has [paused for now](#), but on Monday Iran-backed militias in Iraq and Yemen attacked several of America’s Gulf allies, including Saudi Arabia, with drones.

Emmanuel Macron, **France’s** president, said the **wildfires** blazing in the country’s south-west were France’s “most difficult situation” since the second world war. He warned of “tough” weeks ahead. More than 300,000 people have been evacuated from their homes across France and **Spain**, which has declared its first national emergency because of a wildfire. [Rising temperatures](#) this week could make it harder to fight the fires.

Andy Burnham said his government would “honour every commitment” Britain had made to Ukraine in full, during a visit by **Volodymyr Zelensky**. Ukraine’s president was the first world leader to visit Mr Burnham [since he became prime minister](#) last week. Mr Burnham announced Britain would share technology for

countering drone jamming, and promised to help Ukraine achieve a “full and unconditional ceasefire” with Russia.

Amazon asked American regulators for permission to launch more than 5,000 **satellites** to provide mobile-phone services including voice calls and messaging. The firm hopes to compete with [Elon Musk’s](#) Starlink in the direct-to-device market, which provides services beyond the reach of cell towers. But it is much smaller than its rival, with fewer than 400 satellites in orbit; Starlink controls more than 10,000.

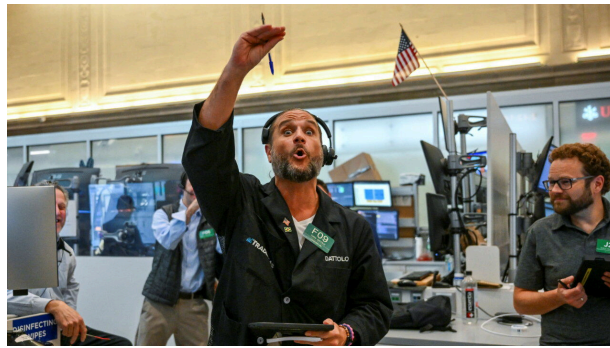
AstraZeneca, Britain’s [second-largest listed company](#), reported strong results for April to June. Profits for that period rose by 18% compared with a year before, beating analysts’ expectations. The drugmaker forecast that profits would continue to rise over the year. It also sought to reassure investors that an unexpectedly poor recent trial of Wainua, a heart-disease treatment, would not harm its long-term prospects.

Nvidia and other tech firms formed an alliance to share technical data (called “weights”) of AI models, and other technology, to improve **cybersecurity**. Such [“open-weight” models](#) can be customised, which Nvidia said can provide the flexibility needed to defend against attacks. Last week Hugging Face, an AI platform, [suffered a cyberattack](#) which it could not contain using leading “closed” models because of usage restrictions.

LVMH reported €19.5m (\$22.2bn) in revenue in the second quarter, beating analysts’ expectations. Sales of clothes and leather goods grew for the first time in two years, driven by American consumers. The French luxury giant said Dior’s growth was “accelerating” after a recent creative overhaul. Earlier Bernard Arnault, LVMH’s billionaire boss, dismissed allegations that his five children were squabbling over [succession](#).

Figure of the day: 8m, the number of barrels of oil that flowed through the Strait of Hormuz each day in early July. In recent days that has fallen to 2m.

Markets face the summer heat



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

Financial markets tend to be jittery in the summer, something [often attributed](#) to inexperienced traders running desks while their bosses laze on a beach. But this week brings even more potential for volatility than usual. The renewed oil-price squeeze, caused by the Strait of Hormuz remaining closed and the Houthis' threats to ships in the Red Sea, has pushed a barrel of Brent crude close to (and briefly above) \$100. The recent pause in fighting has pushed down oil prices, but unless tensions permanently recede—or there is serious demand destruction—crude could still surpass \$120 a barrel by the end of summer.

Big tech's quarterly earnings may shake nerves too. Microsoft and Meta report on Wednesday; Amazon and Apple on Thursday. Investors are anxious about the size of their capital expenditure, and want reassurance that AI bets will pay off. The Federal Reserve also announces its interest-rate decision on Wednesday. Policymakers will probably hold rates, but may hint at further rises if inflation does not ease. After all that, investors may need a holiday.

America prepares to deport Haitian immigrants



Photograph: Getty Images

Some 330,000 Haitians in America will lose Temporary Protected Status on Monday—a designation that lets migrants from countries that the government deems unsafe stay. Haitians were granted TPS after an earthquake in 2010. It has been extended several times as gangs have ravaged Haiti. But in June [America's Supreme Court](#) cleared the way for the Trump administration to end it. The government says it will begin deporting 250 Haitians to Cap Haitien, a gang-free city in the north, each week.

The revocation comes as [violence in Haiti](#) spikes. Earlier this month at least 61 people were killed in a massacre, including 14 children. A recent UN report said that armed gangs were seeking to “capture the systems of governance”. America’s government insists that Haitians no longer need protection, but this month the State Department reissued its grim advice for Americans travelling to Haiti: draft a will and “leave DNA samples” with their medical providers, in case their remains need to be identified.

In with the New in Turkey

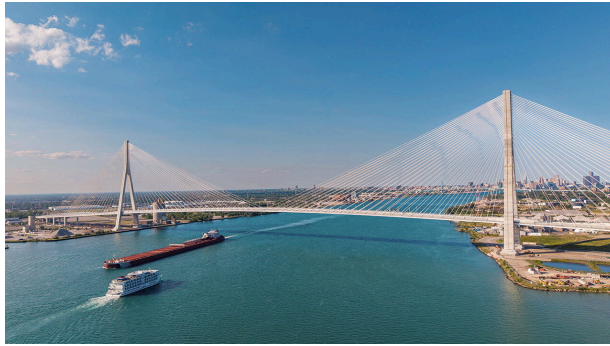


Photograph: Getty Images

For nearly a quarter century, the Republican People's Party (CHP) was Turkey's main opposition. That changed in the blink of an eye on Friday, when Ozgur Ozel, the CHP's recently deposed leader, and his supporters announced the creation of the unimaginatively named New Party (YP). More than 90 CHP parliamentarians have already defected to the YP, making it the biggest opposition party in parliament.

But the YP faces a gauntlet of obstacles before it can mount a serious challenge to Turkey's president, Recep Tayyip Erdogan, and his ruling Justice and Development party. Elections are expected as early as next year; to contest them, the YP will need to organise in at least half of Turkey's 81 provinces and hold a national congress at least six months before. Most importantly, it will need to survive government lawfare. The CHP's presidential candidate, Ekrem Imamoglu, is in prison on trumped-up charges. YP officials may be next in line.

A bridge too far



Photograph: Reuters

On Monday a bridge connecting Michigan and Canada finally opened to traffic. The 2.5km span, which will ease congestion and speed up cross-border trade, had become a pawn in Donald Trump's trade war, and he blocked it from opening in June.

Named for a Canadian hockey player who played for the Detroit Red Wings, the Gordie Howe bridge was conceived in 2012, when Barack Obama was president and Canada and America had a happy relationship. Since then, Mr Trump decided Canada was taking advantage of its powerful neighbour. He has imposed a series of tariffs on Canadian exports, including fresh ones last week. Americans were disinclined from the ribbon-cutting ceremony on Friday, and Mr Trump declared the bridge deal "dead". Locals feared another delay. But by noon, traffic began flowing on schedule. Canadians breathed a sigh of relief: apart from a few confused drivers attempting U-turns mid-span, nothing went awry.

Reasons for concern and hope in the fight against AIDS



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

The 26th International AIDS Conference opens on Monday in Rio de Janeiro. Two things will dominate the meeting of experts, activists and patients. One is how to respond to Donald Trump's America First Global Health Strategy, which will shift more of the burden of fighting the disease from American taxpayers to those in poor countries. The other is the roll-out of Lenacapavir, a drug which, if taken twice-yearly by injection, prevents infection by HIV, the AIDS-causing virus.

HIV-related deaths have fallen from 2m two decades ago to 570,000 last year. America's new approach puts that progress at risk. American support for AIDS programmes in South Africa has ended, and several other places, including Ghana, Zambia and Zimbabwe, are balking at the terms on offer. On the plus side, PEPFAR, America's anti-AIDS agency, which despite presidential hostility has support in Congress, is leading an effort to make Lenacapavir available to 3m people by 2028.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: What sportsman's first names are actually Eldrick Tont?

*Dream is not that which you see
while sleeping it is something that
does not let you sleep.*

A.P.J. Abdul Kalam